

2024 年全国大学生英语竞赛决赛（A 类）
2024 National English Competition for College Students
(Level A-Final)
(Total: 150 marks Time: 120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read only once. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you'll have **fifteen seconds** to read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

1. A. Work late.
B. Buy tickets.
C. Go to a soccer game.
D. Go out with a friend.
2. A. In class.
B. On a plane.
C. On a train.
D. On a bus.
3. A. It's comfortable.
B. It's too large.
C. It's unsafe.
D. It's the right size.
4. A. At a restaurant.
B. At the doctor's.
C. At the office.
D. At a telephone booth.
5. A. She has long, red hair.
B. She has long, black hair.
C. She doesn't wear glasses.
D. She has red hair and wears glasses.

Section B (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **two** long conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause.*

Conversation One

*Listen to the conversation. Then read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

6. What are the speakers discussing?
- A. A book they both read.
 - B. A seminar they will attend.
 - C. A film about the American frontier life.
 - D. A lecture in their American literature course.
7. What does Hamlin Garland describe in his book *Main-Traveled Roads*?
- A. A Boston school.
 - B. American Frontier life.
 - C. Farms in Mid-west America.
 - D. A small town in Wisconsin.
8. How was the pioneer's life in Hamlin Garland's book?
- A. Boring.
 - B. Exciting.
 - C. Hard.
 - D. Cosy.
9. Why does the man mention Julie Peterson?
- A. Because she was a well-known author.
 - B. Because she was inspired by her friend.
 - C. Because she eventually became a famous landowner.
 - D. Because she exemplifies the spirit of the early immigrants.
10. Where's the man going now?
- A. To the frontier.
 - B. To a bookstore.
 - C. To a movie.
 - D. To the library.

Conversation Two

*Listen to the conversation. Then complete the following sentences with **one word** according to what you hear. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

11. The man is doing a survey about people's shopping ____ for a university assignment.
12. The woman usually does her food shopping ____ a week at the supermarket.
13. If the woman shops with her family, they always put too many things in the trolley and it costs her a ____.
14. There are ____ people in the supermarket on Thursday than on Friday according to what the woman said.
15. The woman doesn't like shopping ____ because she likes to see products, walk around the shop and buy things not on her shopping list.

Section C (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each*

item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.

16. What's the weather like?

- A. Cloudy.
- B. Windy.
- C. Rainy.
- D. Sunny.

17. When does the sale end?

- A. At the end of the month.
- B. On the coming weekend.
- C. Next month.
- D. Next week.

18. What is being offered?

- A. Computer repair service.
- B. Computer technician training.
- C. Computer-based employment service.
- D. Computers and related equipment.

19. What will happen after the talk?

- A. Refreshments will be served.
- B. There will be a book sale.
- C. Dr Swanson will sign books.
- D. Another speaker will talk.

20. Which of the following sandwiches can you get at the Green Garden Café?

- A. Cheese and bacon.
- B. Ham and turkey.
- C. Cheese and vegetable.
- D. Roast beef.

Section D (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **one** monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **no more than five words**. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

21. What kind of travellers find they have little time to exercise?

22. Why is it difficult for these travellers to get exercise?

23. Where can travellers exercise on board a plane according to experts?

24. Where can travellers have a good aerobic workout?

25. According to the passage, what is a benefit of exercising regularly?

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

*There are **15** incomplete sentences in this part. For each blank there are **four** choices marked **A, B, C**, and **D**. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

26. It is necessary to have at least one advanced degree in order to ____ in today's job market.

- A. compete

B. compile

C. compose

D. comprise

27. We can't work on a solution until we _____ the source of the problem.

A. internalize

B. idolize

C. intensify

D. identify

28. Mr Lutz is _____ to take on such a big responsibility because he doesn't feel prepared for it at this time.

A. relieved

B. reluctant

C. resigned

D. resistant

29. The best way to _____ people to buy our product is to offer it at a lower price.

A. convince

B. conceive

C. contrive

D. console

30. All packages, bags, and bundles will be _____ by a security officer before leaving the building.

A. probed

B. analyzed

C. inspected

D. reviewed

31. We cannot ship any more orders for the rest of the week because our _____ is low.

A. invitation

B. inventory

C. intake

D. invoice

32. Because Mr Smith was so behind schedule, he willingly _____ his colleague's offer of help.

A. excepted

B. acceded

C. exceeded

D. accepted

33. Our boss is very organized and tidy and _____ that we keep the office neat.

A. insists

B. consists

C. resists

D. persists

34. You should _____ your time sheet by 3:00 every Friday in order to be paid the following week.

A. turn out

B. turn off

C. turn in

D. turn on

35. They bought extra chairs into the room _____ they expected a large number of people to attend the meeting.

A. although

B. nevertheless

C. whereas

D. since

36. You can sign the document now, _____ you can speak to an attorney first if you prefer.

A. so

B. while

C. or

D. for

37. I suggest leaving earlier in the afternoon because _____ 5:00, the subways and buses become very crowded.

A. after

B. to

C. over

D. until

38. —Now, do you have any concerns about the course?

—Well, I must admit there are some aspects of the course that I'm a bit scared of.

—Oh, what are they?

—Well, you can see from my application form that I'm not very good at maths. _____.

—That's very honest of you, but there is no need to worry about that. It's not important for this course.

A. Do you see what I mean?

B. Will that cause me any problems?

C. What interests you about this course?

D. Have you talked to someone who has done this course?

39. —What about laundry? Can I use the washing machine?

—Oh, yes. I expect everyone living here to wash and iron for themselves. _____ Have a nice day!

A. Do you find it helpful?

B. Do you need extra bedsheets?

C. I'm sure it won't take long to settle in.

D. Just let me know when you want to use it.

40. —You mustn't dress too casually for work. Everyone dresses really well in Hong Kong.

—I'll remember that.

—Oh, and you needn't buy lots of guide books before you go. You can get great ones there for a fraction of the price. Also, you ought to take lots of passport photos with you. _____

—Great! I'm getting pretty excited now.

A. We didn't have to worry about those when I was there.

B. Nowadays you have to get a work permit before you go.

C. You'll find you need lots to fill in any application forms.

D. You'll need to allow a bit of extra time to get over the jet lag.

Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in the blanks with the correct forms of **5** words or phrases out of the **7** given in the box. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

found on; benefit; concentrate; commit; effect; prevent from; strong
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The university karate club was created in 1962 and several members of our club have gone on to compete at national level. All grades from beginners to advanced are welcome. The classes are suitable for both men and women.

Unfortunately, over the last few years, assaults on innocent people have increased. Each of us has some ability to defend ourselves, but by earning a form of self-defence, we are not only increasing that ability, but also doing something to build our own sense of self-respect. Karate will show you a lot of simple and (41) _____ techniques to protect yourself, giving you increased self-confidence.

Far too many people think martial arts are about violence. Martial-arts training is (42) _____ a lot of respect, self-discipline, self-control and non-violence. We learn basic etiquette, courtesy and tolerance. Good manners and consideration for others are expected at all times.

Karate is the practice of blocking and striking techniques for the purpose of self-defence, health and self-development. Karate exercises the entire body. Techniques are practised on

both sides of the body, therefore muscle imbalances do not occur and the (43) _____, coordination, flexibility and agility of both sides of the body are improved. Regular training in karate improves the body's physical stamina and suppleness. It also helps (44) _____ and produces the mental calm and assurance that come from knowing we can defend ourselves.

Karate has many benefits, but they do not come easily or overnight. Training requires ongoing (45) _____ and hard work. Some of you give up, but a few of you will get your black belt!

Section B (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word in one of the following **three** ways: according to the context by using the correct form of given word(s), or by using the given letter(s) of the word. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

In the week that the government sets out its new environmental programme, Kevin McCabe and Alicia Stewart consider the problem of food packaging waste.



KM: On my way home from work yesterday, stopped off at my local supermarket. Among other things, I wanted to buy a couple of coconuts. When I picked them up, I was (46) asto_____ that each coconut was wrapped in clear, thin plastic. Isn't this the most stupid example of packaging ever?



AS: You've picked an unusual example of packaging, but there is a reason for this. Supermarkets want to make sure that coconuts reach the consumer in the very best condition. The packaging helps to keep the product fresh; it cuts down the damage if the product gets broken; it stops coconut hairs from getting into other food during transport and it allows supermarkets to put on an information label.



KM: I see. However, the fact is that here in the UK, we throw a huge amount of packaging away—4.9 million tonnes every year. All those cans, jars and boxes add about £ 500 a year to the average food bill. UK supermarkets give out eight billion single-use plastic bags a year. In addition, our streets are full of packaging rubbish, such as water bottles, crisp packets, noodle pots and plastic bags. Isn't it your (47) _____ (responsible) to do something about this?



AS: As a matter of fact, we are doing something. A lot of thought now goes into the design of packaging, so that in many cases we use the minimum amount of material. We're also using more biodegradable materials, and these end up mainly as water vapour. But people shouldn't just blame this problem on the packaging industry. Consumers and governments also need to take (48) _____.



KM: I think they are. The amount of packaging waste that's recovered and recycled in the UK has gone up for a number of years—although this country's record is poor (49) _____ (compare) with other European countries. However, even with biodegradable materials, it's not enough just to put rubbish in a hole in the ground. Without sun, air and water, a rubbish bag that should break up in 15 days could still exist hundreds of years from now.



AS: Yes, that's a problem for planners. Remember too, that changes in society are going on which affect the amount of packaging that's produced. For example, more and more people are living alone and they're eating more (50) conv_____ food. So this issue isn't just about the packaging industry—everyone has to pull together on this.

Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

There are **three** passages in this part. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

Section A (10 marks)

Questions 51—55 are based on the following passage.

After walking for nearly 10 kilometers by China's Huangshan Mountain, and just as he was on the verge of giving up, Phil Lecomte caught sight of a beautiful village.

This moment took place 14 years ago, when the Frenchman travelled to a small town at the foot of the mountain with his camera and backpack.

In 1999, Lecomte travelled to China for the first time. (51) _____ He says that the vast lands and beautiful scenery of China, including mountains, rivers, ancient villages and terraced fields, are things he never forgets.

In 2009, he travelled to Huangshan Mountain in Anhui province, a place that changed his life. As a UNESCO World Heritage Site and world geological park, the mountain is famous for its five wonders: oddly shaped pines, rock formations, seas of clouds, hot springs and winter snow.

(52) _____ Surrounded by mountains and rivers, the district is famous for its Huizhou culture street that has a history of hundreds of years. The Huizhou culture is a unique regional culture that is richly varied, and includes aspects of traditional Chinese science and technology, education, opera and architecture.

“I didn’t want to leave here anymore. I wanted to change my life and be a dreamer like I was when I was a child,” Lecomte said.

His trip to China turned into a long-term stay. “I still remember that the first thing I bought in Tunxi was a tent,” he recalled. (53) ____

In 2012, Lecomte became a tour guide. Unlike other guides, he rarely takes his guests—mostly foreigners—to the most popular attractions. Instead, he searches for unknown scenery in the surrounding area.

“I just open the map app and see if there are any villages around the popular tourist spots. If there are, I will go there and see if it’s worth travelling to.” Lecomte often hikes or rides a motorcycle with his friends, away from the hustle and bustle, to find hidden scenery scattered around Huangshan Mountain, he said.

But they are surprised from time to time. Meadows by streams, ancient villages at the foot of the mountains and inaccessible forests have become “secret destinations” that he brings his friends to revisit again and again.

(54) ____ They sing and play the ukulele by clear streams, chat with locals herding cattle or picking tea, and fall asleep to the sounds of frogs and cicadas.

Sometimes, he also travels with his Chinese tour guide friends. “It’s very interesting that even at the scenic spots that they have visited countless times, they have never been to the places I take them to,” Lecomte said.

Now, he also shares the beautiful moments he captures on his camera on Chinese social media, like images of an old man sitting by the river reading a book against the sunset, or children running around an ancient village waving colourful fish lanterns.

Lecomte has taken more than 118,000 photos in China to date.

“I grew up in Tunxi, and these photos have captured the moments in my memory,” wrote a netizen named Yuehan.

Lecomte likes one of his photos very much: a little girl holding a cartoon umbrella, squatting in the middle of an ancient street and building a snowman with a small shovel in the heavy snow.

“OMG, the girl was me when I was little!” a young Chinese netizen commented shortly after the photo was posted. (55) ____

Lecomte still has a photo of his childhood home. A house with a red roof is reflected in the clear lake, surrounded by forests, like a picturesque oil painting.

“When I was a child, I loved camping in this forest with my friends. When I would wake up at night in my sleeping bag, I could see the stars when I looked up. Now, when I camp on Huangshan, I can also see the stars that can’t be seen in the cities,” he said.

Questions 51—55

Choose from the sentences A—G the one which best fits each gap of 51—55. There are **two extra** sentences which you do not need to use.

- | |
|---|
| <p>A. Lounging on the hillside of the mountain, the view evoked cherished memories.</p> <p>B. He has since travelled to China almost yearly, as the owner of an antiques business in France.</p> <p>C. And the tent was certainly representative of his life in China, spent climbing, hiking and camping in the mountains.</p> <p>D. The world’s most sublime, grotesque and unique views often come from the places which are far away and difficult to access.</p> |
|---|

- E. The magical connection between past and present, and between reality and the internet amazed him.
- F. Lecomte lived in Tunxi district at the foot of Huangshan Mountain for three months.
- G. Lecomte enjoys time spent camping and hiking with his Chinese and foreign friends.

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 56—60 are based on the following passage.



Wayne Gould, an entrepreneur from Hong Kong, first saw Sudoku puzzles when he was visiting Japan in 1997. He went to *The Times* newspaper, based in London, and offered the puzzle to them. They accepted. After Sudoku featured in *The Times* in 2004, it became very popular and spread to the United States. Since then, it has become an international craze, with hundreds of books and Internet sites devoted to the nine-grid of numbers. Many say that the puzzle is strangely addictive. Some individuals cannot go to bed peacefully without having successfully completed that day's puzzle. There have been puzzle crazes in the past such as Rubik's Cube, which was invented in Hungary in 1974, and became very popular all over the world in the 1980s.

Puzzles have a long history and not surprisingly, Sudoku is only one in a long line of puzzles to fascinate human beings. Puzzles have, in fact, existed for thousands of years. For example, the Chinese puzzle tangram has ancient origins and the Egyptians were also known for puzzles in the form of riddles. For example, the Egyptian Pharaoh Zeserkheperure-Setepenre used to test his soldiers with his puzzles. It was not until the 16th century, however, that the word "puzzle" became used. It is derived from a French word and means "to confuse".

In more recent years, among the most popular have been jigsaw puzzles, crossword puzzles, and number puzzles such as Sudoku. In the last 30 years, these puzzles and other new additions have become available electronically and on the Internet.

Jigsaw puzzles were first invented in 1760 by an English engraver and mapmaker called John Spilsbury. Their main purpose was to assist children with their geography education, as they had to put together various maps. The golden age of the jigsaw was in 1920s and '30s, but today they still are a popular pastime.

The most famous puzzle, popular all over the world, is probably the crossword, which appeared in 1913. It was invented by Arthur Wynne and first published in the *New York World*. As

they deal with words and their meanings, there is an almost endless variety of crosswords available. One of the most famous crossword puzzles is published in *The Times* newspaper in England. It is particularly difficult because it is “cryptic”. Cryptic means that the clues to the crosswords themselves are mini-puzzles and use various codes and other tricks to test the puzzler’s skills.

Although various people claim to have invented Sudoku, this popular game is definitely Japanese. The game was initially introduced in Japan in 1984 by Nikoli Co. Ltd. The *Asahi Shimbun* has been running Sudoku puzzles for over ten years. Sales of Sudoku puzzle books are around 4.5 million per month. The word is a shortening of the Japanese phrase “suji wa dokushin ni kagiru” which means “being single is best for numbers”. The puzzles are purely dependent on logic and require no actual mathematical skill. The puzzle has caught on all over the world, and its widespread popularity has surprised many.

Why are puzzles so popular? The main reason is that they are entertaining and cheap. Jigsaw puzzle remained popular in the 1930s depression because of this simple fact. They are also a diversion and a way to forget about daily concerns or worries. They are highly absorbing and sometimes addictive. They are also educational. When jigsaw puzzles were invented, they had a strong educational emphasis. Michael Naylor, a mathematics professor in the United States, describes how sudoku puzzles are great for the development of logical reasoning. They can also be tailored for different ability levels. Instead of using the usual nine-by-nine grid, a four-by-four grid can be used to make the puzzles easier. Crosswords also have clear educational benefits. They aid the development of language, especially vocabulary and also train the mind to become more agile and quick.

In this age, when more and more daily tasks are being automated and human brainwork being taken away from so many things, perhaps we need puzzles to regularly exercise our brains and keep them working well. There are so many good reasons to do puzzles. Why not have a try?

Questions 56 to 60

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

56. What is the transmission route of Sudoku three countries?
57. When was the word “puzzle” first widely used?
58. Where were jigsaw puzzles invented?
59. Why is *The Times* crossword particularly difficult?
60. Why are puzzles so popular?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 61—65 are based on the following passage.



Kathy O'Connor, a Spanish teacher at the Tidewater Community College in Virginia (USA), was amazed when one of her students told her how much

longer she studied after she transferred her language laboratory CDs to her iPod. The student estimated that she spent seven to eight hours a week longer studying than usual. She studied vocabulary and listening comprehension exercises while waiting for something or doing routine tasks such as cleaning. Having the material available via iPod made studying much more convenient and time-efficient. Kathy O'Connor is now pioneering the greater use of iPods in the language classroom. At the beginning of her Spanish courses, she hands out iPods fully loaded with related course materials and songs.

There is no doubt that technology is a useful tool for language learning. Using resources such as iPods, the Internet and CALL (Computer Assisted Language Learning) opens up more options for students and teachers and makes the language learning experience more varied, fun and hopefully more effective.

Technology is only one of the many important factors that one must consider when learning a foreign language. In an ideal world, languages are learned at a young age when one's brain is generally more receptive to learning new things. People who are bilingual or multilingual often grow up in environments where they are exposed to a variety of languages. What about the rest of us?

Academics have never been able to present a unified theory which describes the perfect way to learn a second language. However, they have long highlighted the importance of inputs (such as reading and listening to the target language) and outputs (speaking and writing the target language). The most recent theories suggest, while these skills remain important, we should also consider the context or environment in which the learning is done. The more meaningful and real the context, the more valuable the learning experience. This has led academics to propose a model involving inputs, interaction and outputs.

While time will tell whether a definitive theory can be produced, there are many other practical areas to consider: 1) motivation and hard work; 2) knowledge of how the brain works; 3) understanding yourself as a learner and learner skills; and 4) the importance of culture.

Motivation is essential to learning and mastering a new language. If you are sufficiently motivated to learn a language, you will learn it. Students must understand the reasons for their motivation. Maybe it's to get a better job, or maybe it's because you have fallen in love with an Italian!

Closely related to motivation is hard work. Everyone agrees that the more time you spend learning a language, the better you will get. Naturally, what you study and how you study are also essential. If you can have fun and be creative while you are learning, that's even better. Many find it is also more fun to learn while carrying out a task like planning a holiday in your target language.

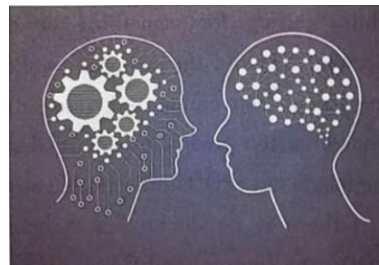
There has been a general increase in the awareness of how techniques such as memorization can strengthen language learning skills. One useful memory skill that has existed for a long time but is now being more widely used is mnemonics, a technique in which you link words in the target language to ones you already know. It has been argued that 50 percent of communication in a language uses just 100 words. If this is true, then imagine how quickly you could master the basics of any language!

Understanding yourself also helps. What kind of learner are you? When do you study best? Do you prefer studying alone or with other people? Do you prefer reading books or watching movies? Learner skills must be considered too—how you make notes of new words, how

effectively you can use a dictionary, and manage time.

Learning a new language means learning a new culture. In some ways, when you learn another language, you have to forget who you are and become a new person. If you always think in terms of your first language and culture, you will never become good at a second language. Try to dream in a foreign language!

It is said that the greatest linguist currently alive is Ziad Fazah from Brazil. He can speak 58 languages! Most of us probably don't want or need to speak that many, but if we can appreciate some of the key elements of learning a foreign language, we might be able to speak three or four. Why don't you start developing your foreign language skills today?



Questions 61 to 65

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using **no more than three words** for each blank.

Although many of us dream of being a linguist, the truth is that we often lack the (61) ____ to learn a new language because it is essential to learning and mastering a new language. Closely related to it is (62) _____. Everybody has their own language learning styles. We should understand ourselves well and know that learning a new language means learning (63) _____. However, today technology offers many different options in language learning so that we can make language learning more varied, fun and hopefully (64) _____. Another factor in helping us learn a new language is research that shows us that in terms of the number of words we need to learn, mastering the (65) _____ of a language does not really require that much effort.

Part V Translation (15 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

66. The blue light emitted by devices such as smartphones and tablets may give a boost to your appetite. Research has found that your appetite continued to increase when you are exposed to the blue light. It also altered people's metabolism. Blood tests showed that the blue-light subjects had higher insulin (胰岛素) and glucose (葡萄糖) levels. One possible explanation is that bright blue light at night confuses our body clock, which has a role in controlling when we feel the need to eat.

Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

67. 几个世纪以来, 全球化在很大程度上是由海洋形成的。当西方海洋国家通过殖民扩张迅速发展时, 内陆国家却陷入了灾难和贫困的循环中。在过去的十年里, 一项变革性倡议开始打破这种循环, 并正在振兴内陆国家的经济。这就是成立于 2013 年的“一带一路”倡议。根据世界银行的数据, “一带一路”倡议可以将全球贸易成本降低 1.8%。“一带一路”倡议吸引了全球四分之三以上国家的参与, 大大改善了世界 30% 人口的生活。不应忘记, 中国在不太富裕国家发展基础设施方面的作用是西方殖民统治者从未做过的。

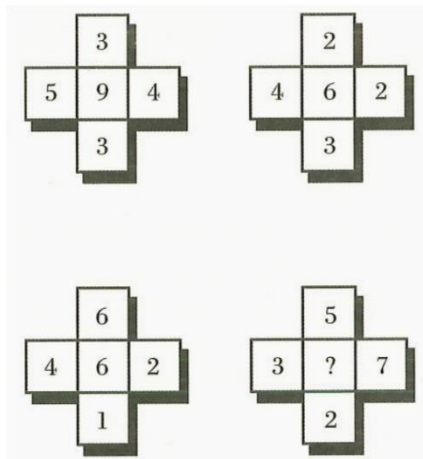
Part VI IQ Test (10 marks)

There are **five** IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

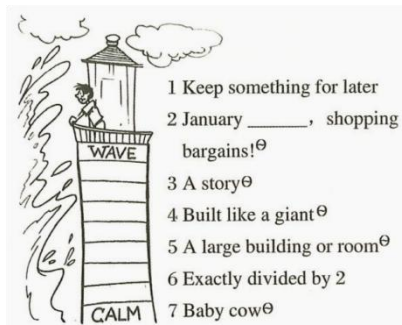
68. What is dark but made by light?

69. They are twins and they work together. They are near but they can't see each other. Who are they?

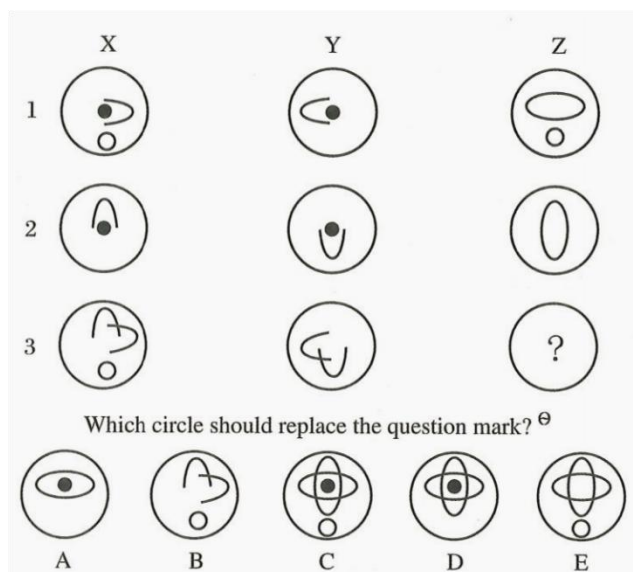
70. Find a number to complete the last cross.



71. Looks like Joe's in for a soaking! Change one letter of the word WAVE to match the first clue and write it on the lighthouse. Carry on down until you've made the wave CALM!



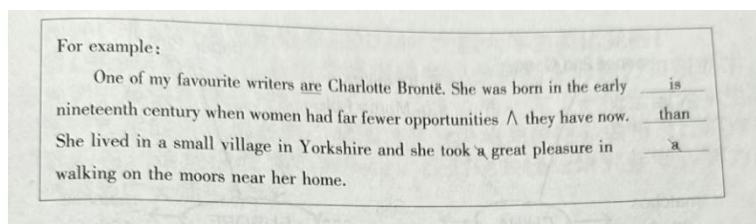
72.



Part VII Error Correction (10 marks)

There are 10 errors altogether in the following passage. The errors are: missing words, unnecessary words and wrong words. Please correct them as follows: for a missing word, mark its position with the symbol “^” and write it; for an unnecessary word, cross it out with the symbol “\”; for a wrong word, underline it and write the correct word. An example of how to correct the error is provided below. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

排的时候可以按图里面这个修改，加那种斜线什么的，改完把图和这段文字删除即可



For example :

One of my favourite writers are Charlotte Bronte. She was born in the early is nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities 增添符 they have now. than She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took a great pleasure in a walking on the moors near her home

I read your story “Not so jolly hockey” (20 October) with greatly 73. ____
interest as, for the last few weeks. I have been travelling around the
country, talked to young people about minority sports. The 74.
youngsters that I met up were doing a wide variety of minority 75.
sports (e.g. fencing, gymnastics, archery) and they were all
enthusiastic and dedicated. However, they were also sad, disappointing 76.
and angry about the lack of media interest in their sports, and also
about poor facilities and funding. All over the country, I heard a same 77.
comment: “If we have more funding, we would do really well in 78.
international competitions. Let’s give the young people of this country
a real chance improve their fitness, show their talents and achieve success. 79.
We need proper government invest in facilities and training. We also 80.

need a sympathetic medium that tell young people about less well-known sports in order to develop their interest. I believe it is now time of the government and media to show the same commitment to minority sports as the young people who do them.

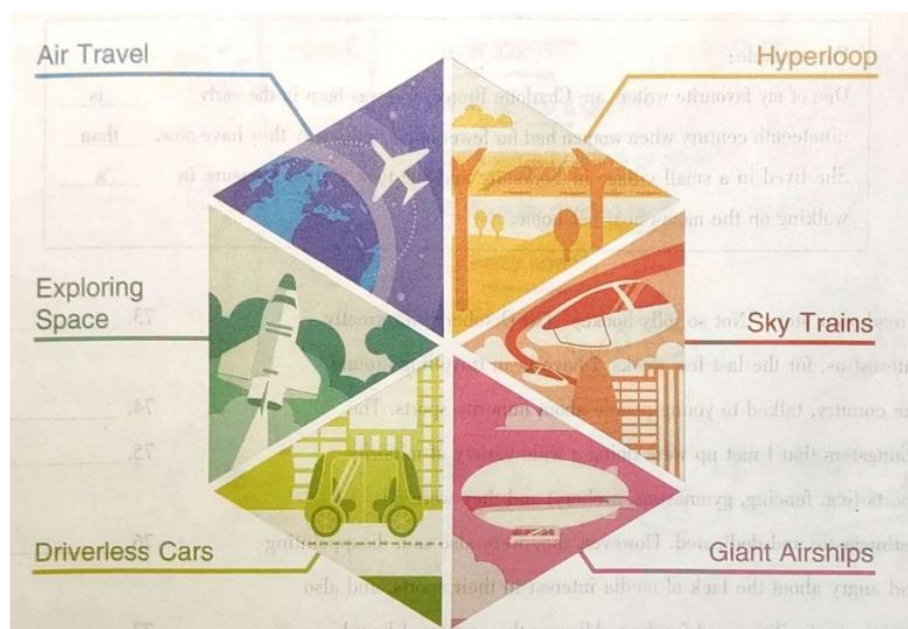
81.

82.

Part VII Writing (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

83. The following pictures focus on making travel predictions. Read the information and think of these two questions: What kinds of transportation do you think we will have in the future? How do you think current modes of transportation will change? Please write a report based on your answers.



Write the report in at least 120 words on the answer sheet.

Section B (20 marks)

84. Write about the following topic.

Some professors give exams or quizzes often, perhaps once a week; in contrast, other professors give only one comprehensive exam at the end of the course. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of each type of exam schedule. Then indicate which you prefer and why.

Write an article of at least 180 words in an appropriate style on the answer sheet.